

Discrete - Time LTI Systems

Scaled, Delayed DT unit impulse $\alpha \delta[n-k]$

As learned previously, $\delta[n]$ is a kick of height 1 at $n=0$.

However with some calculus, we can easily generalise it more.

$$\delta[n] = \begin{cases} 1 & \text{if } n=0 \\ 0 & \text{if } n \neq 0 \end{cases} \quad \xrightarrow{\text{Generalised}} \quad \alpha \delta[n-k] = \begin{cases} \alpha & \text{if } n=k \\ 0 & \text{if } n \neq k \end{cases}$$

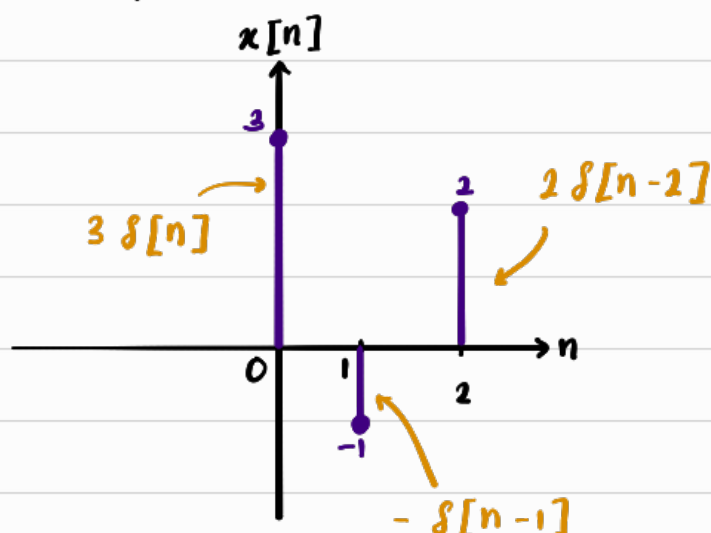
$\alpha \delta[n-k]$ just means put value/sample of height α at k

Discrete - Time Sifting formula

Since every DT signal is just a collection of samples, we can represent each samples with scaled (weighted), delayed (shifted) impulse.

$$x[n] = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} \underbrace{x[k]}_{\text{Value to place}} \underbrace{\delta[n-k]}_{\text{position of value, } x[k]}$$

Example



Concept :

n : Which signal do I want to reconstruct ?

k : Run through all samples to find the one that contributes

$$\therefore \text{Summing up the samples gives} \\ x[n] = 3\delta[n] - \delta[n-1] + 2\delta[n-2]$$

We have just learned how to reconstruct signals, $x[n]$ using impulses. Now we run this signal into a system.

Impulse Response, $h[n]$

The impulse response, $h[n]$ is the system output when the input signal, $x[n]$ is the unit impulse, $\delta[n]$

Suppose

$$x \rightarrow \boxed{\text{System}} \rightarrow y$$

If we let $x[n] = \delta[n]$, then by definition $y[n]$ is the impulse response, $h[n]$.

$$\delta[n] \rightarrow \boxed{\text{System}} \rightarrow h[n]$$

$h[n]$ is essentially telling us the system's complete response pattern to one unit input sample at $n = 0$

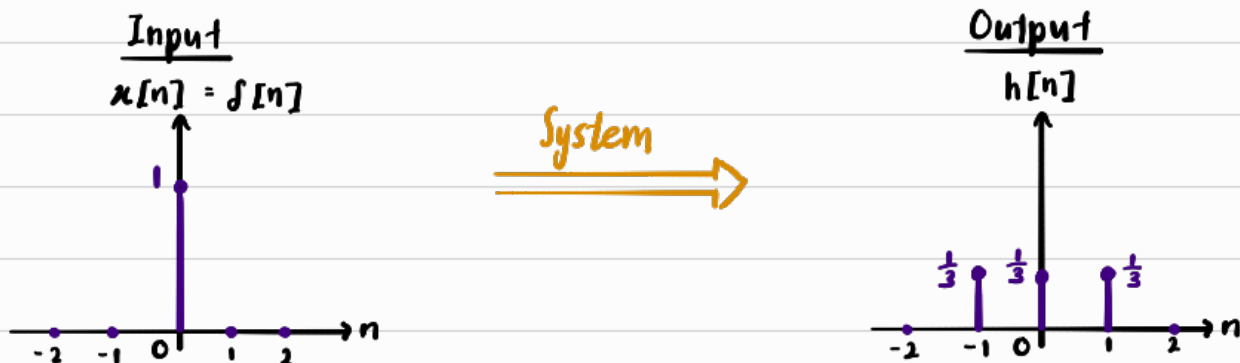
Example 1 [Non Recursive]

Find impulse response, h to the 3-point avg system below

$$y[n] = \frac{1}{3} [x[n] + x[n-1] + x[n-2]]$$

$$\text{Let } x[n] = \delta[n]$$

$$\Rightarrow h[n] = \frac{1}{3} [\delta[n] + \delta[n-1] + \delta[n-2]]$$



So $h[n]$ tells us that the system takes one sample and spread its effect across 3 output samples

Example 2

Find the impulse response, h of $y[n] = 0.5 y[n-1] + x[n]$

with initial rest — $y[n] = 0, n < 0$

$$\text{Let } x[n] = \delta[n] \implies h[n] = 0.5 h[n-1] + \delta[n]$$

At $n = 0$:

$$h[0] = 0.5 h[-1] + \delta[0]$$

$$= 0 + 1$$

$$h[0] = 1$$

At $n = 1$:

$$h[1] = 0.5 h[0] + \delta[1]$$

$$= 0.5 [1] + 0$$

$$h[1] = 0.5$$

At $n = 2$:

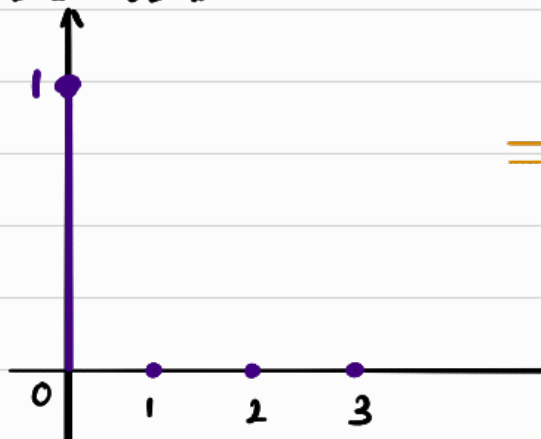
$$h[2] = 0.5 h[1] + \delta[2]$$

$$= 0.5 [0.5] + 0$$

$$h[2] = 0.25$$

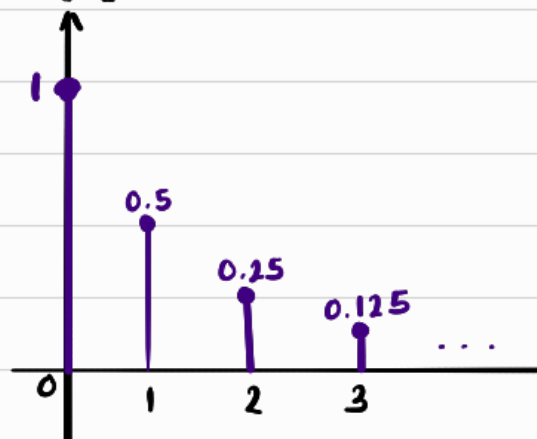
$$\therefore h[n] = (0.5)^n u[n]$$

Input
 $x[n] = \delta[n]$



System $\implies$

Output
 $h[n]$



The impulse only occurred once, but cuz the system uses its previous output as an input, that one impulse input caused a "domino effect"

Some Extra Terminology

Finite Impulse Response (FIR)

$h[n]$ is non-zero finitely many times

E.g. Example 1 : 3-point avg $[n=1, 2, 3]$

Infinite Impulse Response (IIR)

$h[n]$ is non-zero infinitely many times

E.g. Example 2 : $h[n] = (0.5)^n u[n]$

This begs the question : If I already know the system's response to $\delta[n]$, can I predict its response to every one of those shifted impulses, $\delta[n-k]$?

~ For an LTI system, Yes.

Step 1 : Shift/Delay the impulse

Because the system is time-invariant, waiting k samples before applying the input cannot change the system behaviour.

So its entire response also just delays by k samples

$$\boxed{\delta[n-k] \rightarrow h[n-k]} \quad \text{--- ①}$$

Step 2 : Scale the input impulse

Cuz the real input samples don't all have height 1, we scale the impulse by the actual sample height.

$$\boxed{\delta[n-k] \rightarrow x[k] \delta[n-k]}$$

Because of Linearity $[f(ax) = a f(x)]$

$$\boxed{x[k] \delta[n-k] \rightarrow x[k] h[n-k]} \quad , \text{ using ①}$$

Step 3 : Add every impulse together

Remember $x[n] = \sum_k x[k] \delta[n-k]$, so an arbitrary input contain lots of individual samples.

$$x[0] \delta[n] + x[1] \delta[n-1] + x[2] \delta[n-2] + \dots$$

And for each individual sample we do step 2

$$x[k] \delta[n-k] \rightarrow x[k] h[n-k]$$

Because the system is linear, superposition holds so we add all those individual impulse response to each individual sample

Convolution $[y[n] = (x * h)[n]]$

x convolved with h

$$y[n] = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} x[k] h[n-k]$$

Impulse response at k
[System behavior at k of unit input impulse]

Scales the system behaviour to the actual input sample value

Convolution Concept

Every input impulse, $\delta[n-k]$ creates its own copy of the impulse response where then the copy is...

- 1) Shifted to where the input sample occurred
- 2) Scaled by the input sample's height

Then the output = sum of all those response copies.

$h[n]$

We are essentially finding the pattern/behaviour from a single impulse at $n=0$, $\delta[n]$. Then cuz the system is LTI, we can freely scale and delay $h[n]$ in accordance to the "impulse interpretation" of input signal, $x[n]$

Example

Using the same 3-point avg eqn, we already know

$$h[n] = \frac{1}{3} [\delta[n] + \delta[n-1] + \delta[n-2]]$$

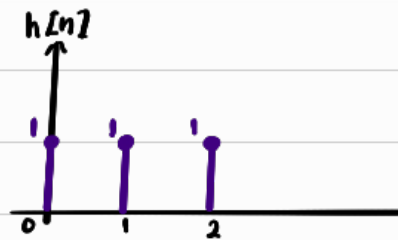
Let's assume we have this input signal

$$x[n] = 3\delta[n] - \delta[n-1] + 2\delta[n-2]$$

1st sample : $3\delta[n]$

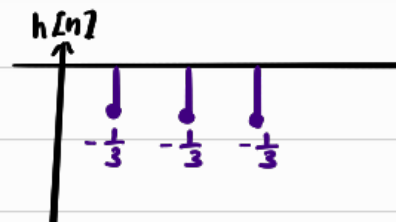
Since $\delta[n] \xrightarrow{\text{creates}} h[n]$, and our system is linear
 $\Rightarrow 3\delta[n] \xrightarrow{\text{creates}} 3h[n]$

$$3h[n] = \delta[n] + \delta[n-1] + \delta[n-2]$$



2nd sample : $-\delta[n-1]$

Since $\delta[n] \rightarrow h[n]$
 $\delta[n-1] \rightarrow h[n-1]$ (Time Invariant)
 $-\delta[n-1] \rightarrow -h[n-1]$ (Linear)



$$-h[n-1] = -\frac{1}{3}(\delta[n-1] + \delta[n-2] + \delta[n-3])$$

3rd sample : $2\delta[n-2]$

Since $\delta[n] \rightarrow h[n]$
 $\delta[n-2] \rightarrow h[n-2]$ (Time Invariant)
 $2\delta[n-2] \rightarrow 2h[n-2]$ (Linear)

So finally to get $y[n]$, we just add up each sample's contribution.

$$y[n] = 3h[n] - h[n-1] + 2h[n-2]$$

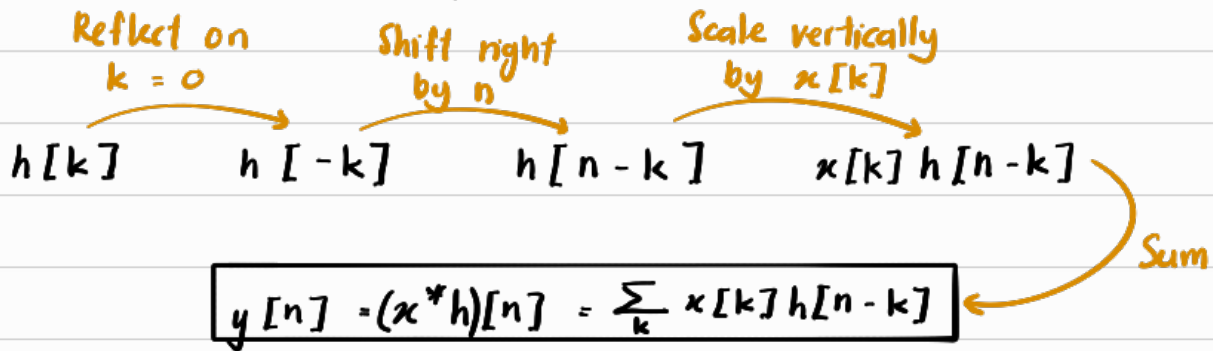
$$y[n] = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} x[k] h[n-k]$$

Graphical Interpretation of Convolution

This subtopic is just about convoluting graphically $x[n]$ and $h[n]$.

Theoractically, the transformation that take place are the following...

For a chosen n , we are given $x[k]$ and $h[k]$



Take note $h[-(k-n)]$

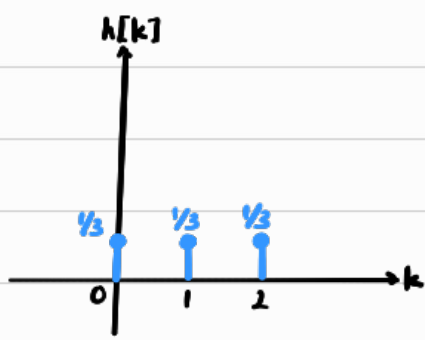
$h[-k] \rightarrow h[n-k]$ is NOT shift left by n .

$$\begin{aligned} \text{let } h[-k] &= g(k) \\ h[-(k-n)] &= g(k-n) \end{aligned} \quad \left. \begin{array}{l} \\ \end{array} \right\} \begin{array}{l} \text{Right shift} \\ \text{by } n \end{array}$$

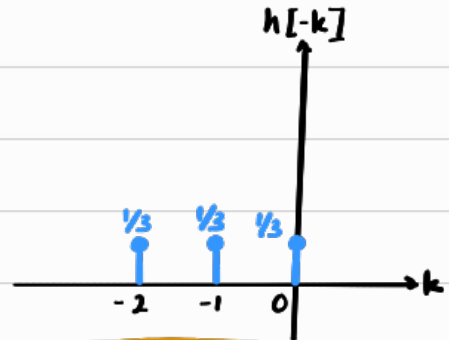
Example

Using back the 3-point avg, we have the following

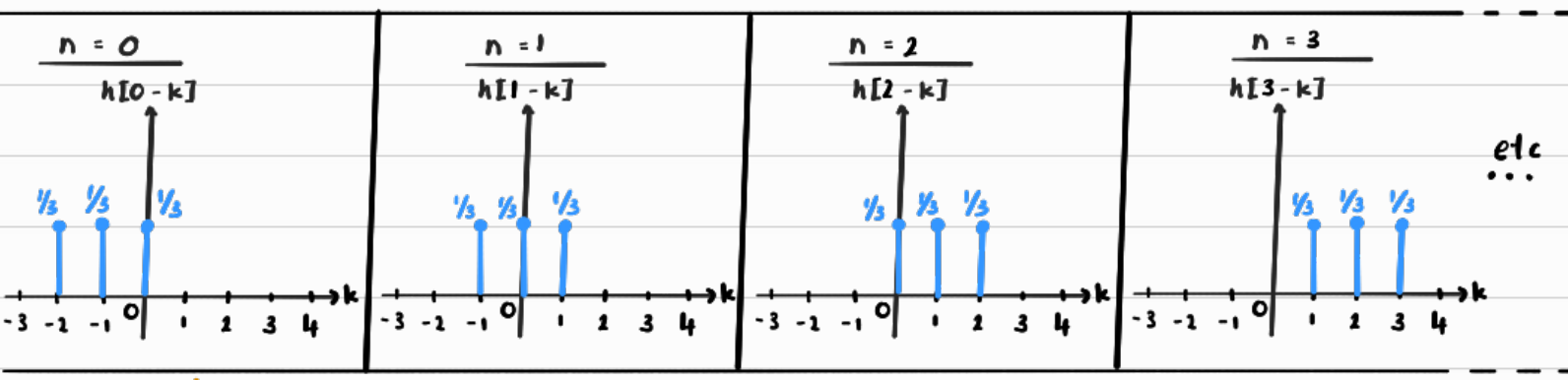
$x[k] = 3\delta[k] - \delta[k-1] + 2\delta[k-2]$; $h[k] = \frac{1}{3}(\delta[k] + \delta[k-1] + \delta[k-2])$



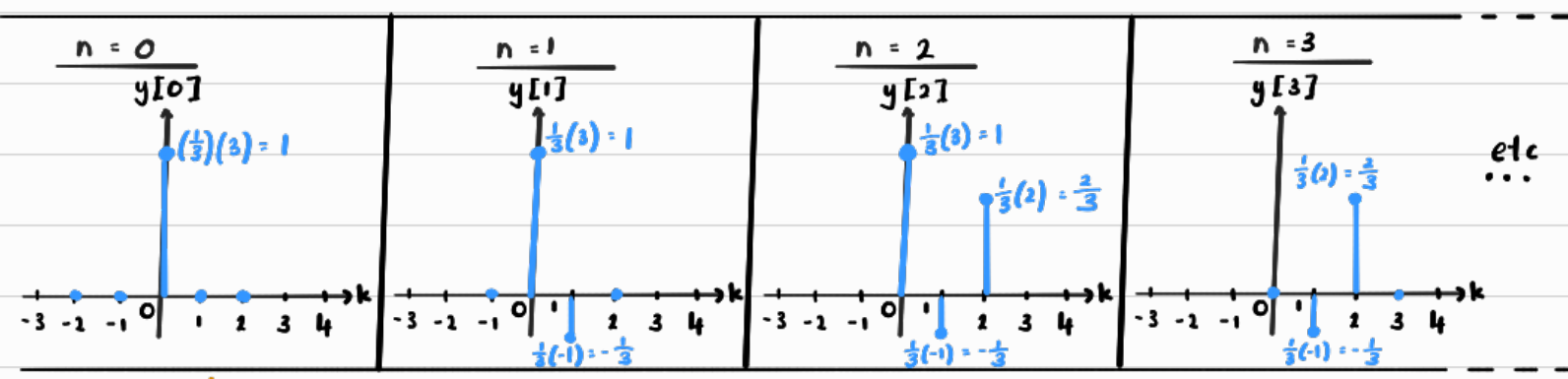
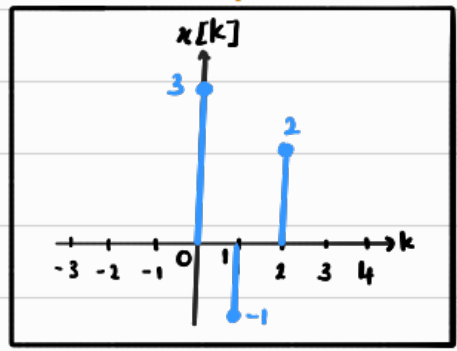
Flip about $k=0$
 $h[-k]$



Shift right by n



Scale vertically by $x[k]$



Sum $[N \times 1 \text{ } P_q]$

Table Form

	$x[0]$	$x[1]$	$x[2]$	
	$k = 0$	$k = 1$	$k = 2$	Sum
$n = 0$	1	0	0	$y[0] = 1$
$n = 1$	1	$-\frac{1}{3}$	0	$y[1] = 1 + (-\frac{1}{3}) = \frac{2}{3}$
$n = 2$	1	$-\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{2}{3}$	$y[2] = 1 + (-\frac{1}{3}) + \frac{2}{3} = \frac{4}{3}$
$n = 3$	0	$-\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{2}{3}$	$y[3] = -\frac{1}{3} + \frac{2}{3} = \frac{1}{3}$
$n = 4$	0	0	$\frac{2}{3}$	$y[4] = \frac{2}{3}$
$n = 5$	0	0	0	$y[5] = 0$
$\vdots$		$\vdots$		$\vdots$

$$\therefore y[n] = \delta[n] + \frac{2}{3}\delta[n-1] + \frac{4}{3}\delta[n-2] + \frac{1}{3}\delta[n-3] + \frac{2}{3}\delta[n-4] \quad \#$$

Overall Concept Check :

We first "test the waters" of an LTI system with one unit impulse $\delta[n]$ to get the system's basic response/behaviour pattern $h[n]$.

Because the system is Linear & Time Invariant, every actual input sample $x[k]$ produces its own scaled & shifted copy of this system's basic response/behaviour pattern $x[k]h[n-k]$.

At any particular time n , we collect the contribution from all input samples $x[k]$ and sum them up.

$$y[n] = \sum_k x[k] h[n-k]$$

k : Which input sample is contributing/overlapping

n : Which output sample we are finding

Sequence Table Method

still using the same 3-point avg where

$$x[n] = 3\delta[n] - \delta[n-1] + 2\delta[n-2]$$

$$h[n] = \frac{1}{3}(\delta[n] + \delta[n-1] + \delta[n-2])$$

	k	-2	-1	0	1	2	3	4
	$x[k]$	0	0	3	-1	2	0	0
	$h[k]$	0	0	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	0	0
$n=0$	$h[-k]$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	0	0	0	0
$n=1$	$h[1-k]$	0	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	0	0	0
$n=2$	$h[2-k]$	0	0	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	0	0
$n=3$	$h[3-k]$	0	0	0	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	0
$n=4$	$h[4-k]$	0	0	0	0	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$	$\frac{1}{3}$

$$y[0] = x[k] h[-k]$$

$$= 3\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$$

$$y[0] = 1 \neq$$

$$y[2] = x[k] h[2-k]$$

$$= 3\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + (-1)\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + 2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$$

$$= \frac{4}{3} \neq$$

$$y[4] = x[k] h[4-k]$$

$$= 2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$$

$$= \frac{2}{3} \neq$$

$$y[1] = x[k] h[1-k]$$

$$= 3\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + (-1)\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$$

$$= \frac{2}{3}$$

$$y[3] = x[k] h[3-k]$$

$$= (-1)\left(\frac{1}{3}\right) + 2\left(\frac{1}{3}\right)$$

$$= \frac{1}{3}$$

Properties of Convolution

identity element

$$① x * \delta = x$$

Obviously, since you are just scaling each sample by 1.

$$② x * h = h * x \quad [\text{Commutative}]$$

It makes sense since it doesn't really matter who is sliding/shifting

$$③ h_1 * (h_2 * h_3) = (h_1 * h_2) * h_3 \quad [\text{Associative}]$$

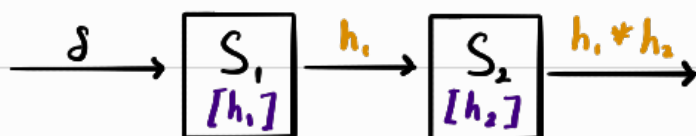
$$④ h_1 * (h_2 + h_3) = (h_1 * h_2) + (h_1 * h_3) \quad [\text{Distributive}]$$

Convolution essentially is just sliding one signal over the other, multiplying then adding the results.

Since who sliding over who doesn't matter, convolution just obeys the properties of multiplication

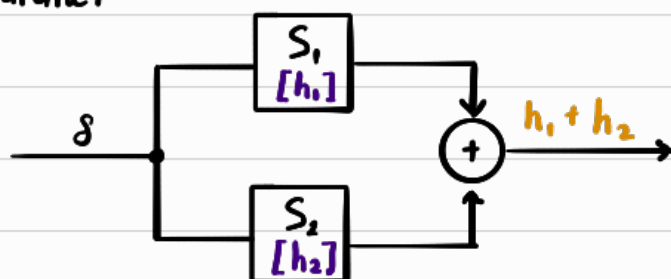
Series & Parallel LTI systems

① Series



$$h_{\text{series}} = h_1 * h_2$$

② Parallel



$$h_{\text{parallel}} = h_1 + h_2$$

Systems in general : $S_1(S_2(x)) \neq S_2(S_1(x))$

But for single input single output Discrete LTI systems,
 $h_1 * h_2 = h_2 * h_1$ is true

$$\therefore S_1(S_2(x)) = S_2(S_1(x))$$

The impulse response is commutative, so is the systems.

Extracting system properties from impulse response, $h[n]$

Since $h[n]$ completely describes an LTI system, properties of the system must appear somewhere in $h[n]$

$$\text{Version 1} \quad y[n] = x * h = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} x[k] h[n-k] \quad \text{OR} \quad \text{Version 2} \quad y[n] = h * x = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} h[k] x[n-k]$$

↪ Remb that convolution is commutative ↪

① Memoryless $y[n]$ only depends on the current input, $x[n]$

Using version 2, for $y[n]$ to only depend on $x[n] \implies k = 0$

$\therefore$ That means only $x[n]$ will not get scaled [and every other term = 0]

$$\implies h[k] = 0 \text{ for } k \neq 0$$

↓ Rewritten with impulse

$$h[n] = \alpha \delta[n]$$

$\therefore$ Every memoryless DT LTI system is just a gain system

$$y[n] = (\alpha \delta[n])(x[n])$$

$$y[n] = \alpha x[n]$$

② Causality $y[n]$ only depends on the present or past

Using version 2, for $y[n]$ to not depend on the future $\implies k \geq 0$

$\therefore$ That means all future signals will not get scaled

$$\implies h[n] = 0 \text{ for } n < 0$$

③ BIBO stability

Referring to version 2

Assuming the input signal is bounded, a system is BIBO stable if the impulse response (system behavior), $h[n]$...

1) Has finite valued samples

However for our course, we are only working with ordinary finite-valued signal samples.

2) Has finitely many non-zero values. [Absolutely summable]

$$\sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} |h[k]| < \infty$$

Bcz an infinite sum of finite values is still not bounded.

Take note:

As we learned previously, Finite Impulse Response (FIR) by definition has only finitely many non-zero values.

$\therefore$ Every FIR DT LTI system is BIBO stable

Continuous-Time LTI systems

Conceptually, CT LTI systems convolution works the same way, just that rather than $\sum$ summing individual samples, we integrate continuously over time

Overall Translation

Discrete Time	Continuous time
n	t
dummy index, k	dummy index, τ
$\delta[n]$	$\delta(t)$
$\sum_k$	$\int d\tau$
$x[k]$	$x(\tau)$
$h[n-k]$	$h[t-\tau]$

For the following explanations, I'll only touch on things that DT and CT differs by.

Scaled, Shifted CT unit impulse

$$\delta(t) = \begin{cases} \infty & \text{if } t = 0 \\ 0 & \text{if } t \neq 0 \end{cases} \quad \xrightarrow{\text{Generalised}} \quad \delta(t - \tau) = \begin{cases} \infty & \text{if } t = \tau \\ 0 & \text{if } t \neq \tau \end{cases}$$

$\delta(t)$ is an infinitely narrow, infinitely tall idealised pulse with unit area

$$\text{Property: } \int_{t_0 - \epsilon}^{t_0 + \epsilon} \delta(t - t_0) dt = 1$$

Take note:

For DT, $\delta[n]$: Unit height at one discrete sample

For CT, $\delta(t)$: Unit area at one continuous time location

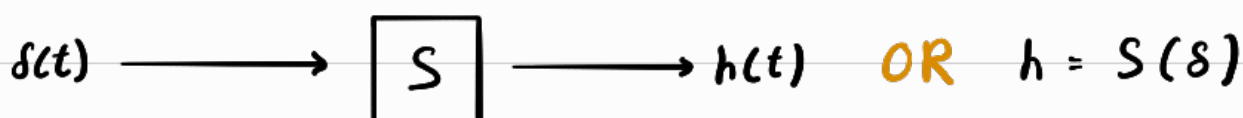
Sifting Formula for CT

Same concept as DT sifting formula, just that now its integrate and uses "unit area, $\delta(t)$ " rather than "unit height, $\delta[n]$ ".

$$x(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau) \delta(t-\tau) d\tau$$

CT Impulse Response, $h(t)$

Same concept as discrete.



CT Convolution

Same concept as DT LTI.

$$y(t) = x * h = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau) h(t-\tau) d\tau$$

Graphical CT Convolution

Same process as DT Convolution, just that "sum" become integrate



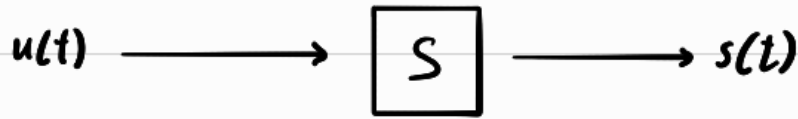
Properties of CT Convolution

Same as DT

- ① $\delta * h = h$ [Identity]
- ② $x * h = h * x$ [Commutative]
- ③ $h_{series} = h_1 * h_2$
- ④ $h_{parallel} = h_1 + h_2$
- ⑤ $S_1(S_2(x)) = S_2(S_1(x))$ [For single input single output CT LTI systems]

Step Response, $s(t)$

The step response is the system output when input = $u(t)$



Remember / Realise that an integrator turns an impulse into a step.
 $\int_{-\infty}^t \delta(\tau) d\tau = u(t)$

So similarly I can say integrator turns impulse response to step response.

$$s(t) = \int_{-\infty}^t h(\tau) d\tau$$

OR

$$h(t) = \frac{d}{dt} s(t)$$

Reading System Properties from $h(t)$

Using the commutative convolution form

$$y(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(\tau) x(t-\tau) d\tau$$

① Memoryless

Same concept as DT, just with "unit height, $\delta[n]$ " $\longleftrightarrow$ "unit area, $\delta(t)$ "

$$h(t) = \alpha \delta(t)$$

↓ using $y(t) = x * h$

$$y(t) = \alpha x(t)$$

$\therefore$ Every memoryless LTI system is a gain system.

② Causality

Same concept as DT

$$h(t) = 0, t < 0$$

Rmb, a causal system cannot produce a response before receiving that sample at $t = 0$.

③ BIBO stability

In DT : Absolutely Summable

In CT : Absolutely Integrable

$$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} |h(\tau)| d\tau < \infty$$

DT vs CT LTI Summary Table

Conceptual job	Discrete Time (DT)	Continuous Time (CT)
Unit impulse	$\delta[n]$	$\delta(t)$
Key impulse idea	Height 1 at one sample	Unit area concentrated at one time
Sifting formula	$x[n] = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} x[k]\delta[n - k]$	$x(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau)\delta(t - \tau) d\tau$
Dummy variable	k	τ
Impulse response	$\delta[n] \rightarrow h[n]$	$\delta(t) \rightarrow h(t)$
LTI response to shifted impulse	$\delta[n - k] \rightarrow h[n - k]$	$\delta(t - \tau) \rightarrow h(t - \tau)$
Scaled + shifted impulse response	$x[k]\delta[n - k] \rightarrow x[k]h[n - k]$	$x(\tau)\delta(t - \tau) \rightarrow x(\tau)h(t - \tau)$
Output / convolution	$y[n] = (x * h)[n] = \sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} x[k]h[n - k]$	$y(t) = (x * h)(t) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x(\tau)h(t - \tau) d\tau$
Convolution calculation	Flip $\rightarrow$ shift $\rightarrow$ multiply $\rightarrow$ sum	Flip $\rightarrow$ shift $\rightarrow$ multiply $\rightarrow$ integrate
Identity	$x * \delta = x$	$x * \delta = x$
Commutative	$x * h = h * x$	$x * h = h * x$
Series / cascade	$h_{\text{series}} = h_1 * h_2$	$h_{\text{series}} = h_1 * h_2$
Parallel	$h_{\text{parallel}} = h_1 + h_2$	$h_{\text{parallel}} = h_1 + h_2$
Memoryless	$h[n] = \alpha\delta[n]$	$h(t) = \alpha\delta(t)$
Causal	$h[n] = 0, n < 0$	$h(t) = 0, t < 0$
BIBO stable	$\sum_{k=-\infty}^{\infty} h[k] < \infty$	$\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} h(\tau) d\tau < \infty$
Name of stability condition	$h[n]$ is absolutely summable	$h(t)$ is absolutely integrable